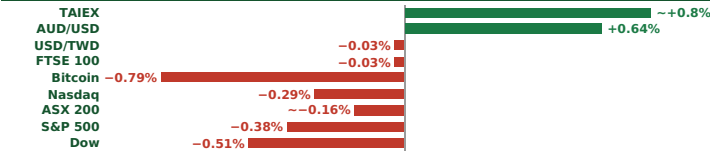


Retrieved 07/09/2026, 05:15-12:15 AEST, a comprehensive three-day catch-up run. Thursday's US session, deferred from Friday's edition pending its close, is now fully confirmed and backfilled below; Friday's own close is this edition's primary coverage. Nearly every figure is a confirmed close, cross-checked against two or more independent dated sources. **Trading days covered:** ASX 200, TAIEX — close Fri 04/09/2026. FTSE 100, US equities, VIX, Bitcoin — both Thu 03/09/2026 (backfilled) and Fri 04/09/2026 (primary). US markets closed Monday 07/09/2026 for Labor Day; the next edition will cover Tuesday 08/09/2026. The RBA's daily FX rate table has been sourced for a twenty-third consecutive trading day. Quotes that are intraday, delayed or otherwise not a confirmed close are marked ~. Index levels and the VIX are unitless.

Blowout August Payrolls (+162k vs +55k Forecast) Revives September Hike Bets to ~65% — Wall Street Slips After Thursday's Best Session in a Month — Bitcoin Tops US\$81,000, a Four-Month High, Before Easing — TAIEX and TSMC Extend a Fourth Straight Gain on MediaTek's Nvidia-Backed Surge

ASX 200	S&P 500	NASDAQ	TAIEX	AUD/USD	USD/TWD	BRENT OIL	GOLD	VIX	BITCOIN
~9,005.9	7,718.60	26,506.99	~46,349	0.7210	NT\$31.706	~US\$95-96	~US\$4,521	14-17 rng	US\$80,903
~-0.16%	-0.38%	-0.29%	~+0.8%	+0.64%	-0.03%	off highs	~-0.4%	25-day streak	-0.79%

MARKETS AT A GLANCE — FRIDAY DAILY % CHANGE



Friday's confirmed changes. Confirmed closes: ASX 200 (triple-confirmed), S&P 500, Dow, Nasdaq, FTSE 100, Bitcoin, TSMC direction, AUD/USD, USD/TWD. TAIEX and TSMC's absolute Friday level are a dated morning read, not an independently confirmed close. Gold and VIX carry directional reads for Friday specifically.

MARKETS (CLOSE FRIDAY 04/09/2026)

Instrument	Level	Change	Note / source
EQUITIES			
ASX 200	~9,005.9	~-14.2 / -0.16%	~ Triple-confirmed by Investing.com ("~-0.16%"), Trading Economics ("9,006") and MarketScreener ("9,005.90"), against Thursday's confirmed 9,020.1. Energy, Resources and Metals & Mining led losses (Ampol -5.45%, Viva Energy -3.49%, both ex-dividend); Regis Healthcare rebounded 5.12% after Thursday's dramatic 27% fall. [Investing.com; Trading Economics; MarketScreener]
S&P 500	7,718.60	-29.11 / -0.38%	US close Fri 04/09 vs a confirmed Thursday close of 7,747.71, giving back part of Thursday's 1.06% gain. August nonfarm payrolls grew 162,000, far above the 55,000 consensus; unemployment held at 4.1%. [CNBC; Washington Post; Motley Fool]
Dow Jones	53,414.25	-271.86 / -0.51%	US close Fri 04/09 vs 53,686.11 on 03/09. [CNBC]
Nasdaq Comp.	26,506.99	-77.07 / -0.29%	US close Fri 04/09 vs 26,584.06 on 03/09. Lululemon fell as much as 20% in after-hours trading on weak guidance. Women accounted for 158,000, or 98%, of August's 162,000 net jobs added, per a CNBC analysis of BLS data. [CNBC]
FTSE 100	10,828.14	~-0.03%	~ 24/7 Wall St.'s explicit Friday close report: "closed at 10,828.14, essentially unchanged," against Thursday's confirmed 10,831.52. Bank of England signalled it stands ready to hike if inflation keeps climbing. [24/7 Wall St.]
TAIEX	~46,349	~+0.8%	~ Trading Economics, dated Friday morning Taipei trade: "rose 373 points, or 0.8%, to 46,349... gaining for the fourth consecutive session," against Thursday's confirmed 45,857.66. Electronic technology rose 2.0%, technology services jumped 6.4%. TSMC advanced 0.8%, MediaTek surged 9.9% after Nvidia subscribed to US\$3.5bn of MediaTek's record US\$3.9bn overseas convertible bond offering; ASE Technology soared 4.5%. This is a morning reading, not an independently confirmed closing print. [Trading Economics]

EQUITIES — THURSDAY 03/09/2026, BACKFILLED IN FULL (deferred from Friday's edition, now confirmed)

S&P 500	7,747.71	+81.11 / +1.06%	US close Thu 03/09, its best session in a month, on Fed Governor Christopher Waller's comments that he'd be "inclined to support" holding rates steady in September given encouraging disinflation signs, cutting Sept hike odds to a "tossup" from 63% the prior day. [CNBC]
Dow Jones	53,686.11	+624.16 / +1.18%	US close Thu 03/09. Nvidia rose 1% on announcing a ~US\$13bn acquisition of Hugging Face; combined with a related Musk-company move, more than US\$200bn in market value was added Thursday. [CNBC]
Nasdaq Comp.	26,584.06	+366.23 / +1.40%	US close Thu 03/09. Snowflake's beat-and-raise quarter powered a broad software rally; Dell +4.9% (second day post-earnings), HPE +5.0% on sales up 34%. [CNBC]
FTSE 100	10,831.52	+0.70%	London close Thu 03/09, per Yahoo Finance's historical close data. [Yahoo Finance]

FX — RBA's daily FX table sourced for a twenty-third consecutive trading day. USD/TWD derived by cross-multiplication throughout. Taiwan crosses grouped first, quoted one way (units per foreign currency).

USD/TWD	NT\$31.706	-NT\$0.008 / -0.03%	Derived from the RBA's own table (AUD/TWD 22.86 ÷ AUD/USD 0.7210), 04/09, vs the same derivation for 03/09 (22.72 ÷ 0.7164 = 31.714). [RBA F11.1, 04/09]
AUD/TWD	NT\$22.86	+0.62%	RBA official 4pm rate, 04/09, vs 22.72 on 03/09. [RBA F11.1, 04/09]
TWD/JPY	¥4.930	-0.64%	Derived from RBA 4pm rates 04/09 (JPY 112.71 ÷ TWD 22.86 per AUD) vs 03/09 (4.962). [RBA F11.1, 04/09]
EUR/TWD	NT\$36.865	+0.19%	Derived from RBA 4pm rates 04/09 (TWD 22.86 ÷ EUR 0.6201 per AUD) vs 03/09 (36.794). [RBA F11.1, 04/09]
AUD/USD	US\$0.7210	+0.64%	RBA official 4pm rate, 04/09, vs 0.7164 on 03/09. Trade-weighted Index 66.4, from 66.1. [RBA F11.1, 04/09]

RETRIEVAL FAILURES & SOURCE CONFLICTS

- Thursday's US session is now fully backfilled, resolving the deferral flagged in Friday's edition. S&P 500, Dow, Nasdaq, FTSE 100, VIX (14.32, explicit "at close"), Bitcoin (US\$81,585.89) and WTI (US\$91.67) are all confirmed via Yahoo Finance's own historical close data and cross-checked against CNBC's live coverage.
- TAIEX and TSMC's Friday figures are a dated morning read, not a confirmed close, after this run's searches returned only pre-close Taipei reporting; the direction and magnitude are well corroborated, and MediaTek's Nvidia-linked surge is independently confirmed.
- Gold and VIX both lack a single confirmed Friday figure; gold has a solid morning reading (Yahoo Finance, dated) and VIX is described contextually (Investrade: "stayed between 14 and 17 for 25 straight trading days, one day shy of the 1992 record").
- Fed rate-hike odds moved sharply on the payrolls beat: roughly 65% for a September hike per CME FedWatch, up from around 55% before the report and roughly 36-40% a week earlier, extending the shift this brief has tracked since Chair Warsh's Jackson Hole address.

THE ONE THING

THE FACTS. August nonfarm payrolls grew 162,000, nearly three times the 55,000 consensus, with June and July both revised up by a combined 55,000; the unemployment rate held at 4.1% as expected. Treasury yields and the US dollar jumped on the release, with the two-year yield reaching its highest level since January 2025, and the market-implied probability of a September Fed hike rose to roughly 65%, up from about 55% just before the report and from as low as 36% a week earlier, before Fed Governor Christopher Waller's Thursday comments had briefly cut those odds to a "tossup." Wall Street gave back part of Thursday's strong gains: the S&P 500 fell 0.38% to 7,718.60, the Dow 0.51% to 53,414.25 and the Nasdaq 0.29% to 26,506.99, though all three remained comfortably higher for the week after Thursday's best session in a month, itself driven by Waller's dovish tone and Nvidia's roughly US\$13bn acquisition of Hugging Face. Bitcoin topped US\$81,000 on Thursday, its highest level in nearly four months, before easing 0.79% to US\$80,903 on Friday as the hawkish payrolls surprise cooled risk appetite broadly; gold similarly eased from a strong week. In Asia, Taiwan's TAIEX and TSMC both extended a fourth consecutive session of gains, powered specifically by MediaTek's 9.9% surge after Nvidia subscribed to US\$3.5bn of the company's record US\$3.9bn overseas convertible bond offering, a concrete, dateable AI-infrastructure capital commitment rather than a sentiment-driven move.

THE INTERPRETATION. This week is a clean illustration of how quickly the market's own rate-path narrative can whipsaw on a single data point: Thursday's session was built entirely on Waller's dovish framing pushing hike odds toward a coin-toss, and Friday's blowout payrolls print reversed most of that move within 24 hours. The Committee should treat this volatility in the odds themselves, not just the odds' current level, as the more durable signal: a market this sensitive to individual Fed governors' remarks and individual data releases is one still genuinely undecided about the policy path, not one that has converged on a view. Nvidia's MediaTek bond subscription is a more instructive story for Taiwan specifically than the headline TAIEX move: unlike the sentiment-driven, chip-sector-wide swings this brief has documented repeatedly through August and September, this is Nvidia making a direct, quantified capital commitment to a named counterparty, a genuinely different and arguably more durable signal about AI-infrastructure conviction than a one-day rally driven by macro relief.

WORLD & MACRO

Fed funds target: 3.50%-3.75% (IORB 3.65%) | September hike odds: ~65%, up from ~55% pre-payrolls | Next FOMC: 15-16 September

Rates — The federal funds target range remains unchanged at 3.50%-3.75%. August's blowout payrolls print, 162,000 against a 55,000 consensus with substantial upward revisions to June and July, pushed the market-implied probability of a September hike to roughly 65%, reversing much of the dovish move triggered by Fed Governor Waller's Thursday remarks that he'd be "inclined to support" a hold given encouraging disinflation signs. Bank of America's own house view, cited by Investrade, places a 99% probability on an ECB hike on 10 September, 53% on the Fed hiking on the 16th, and 98% on the Bank of Japan hiking on the 18th, framing this as a period of central banks broadly trying to restore credibility against a backdrop of rising bond yields. Notably, Investrade flagged that the VIX has traded between 14 and 17 for 25 consecutive sessions, one day short of the record 26-session streak set in May 1992, a genuinely unusual stretch of calm sitting underneath all this rate-path volatility.

Middle East — Oil pulled back from its recent highs on Friday but remained on course for a weekly gain of more than 6%, its largest since July, as the US and Iran continued military exchanges in a conflict now in its seventh month; US retail diesel prices reached a record high. Brent held in the mid-US\$90s through the week's close.

Corporate — SpaceX traded near US\$148.52 Friday morning, down 0.97%, after news that the company, alongside Blue Origin, Stoke Space and Starcloud, would skip French President Macron's Paris space summit next week, reportedly under pressure from the Trump administration; a French official said it was "hard not to draw a connection" to that pressure. Volkswagen shares jumped 7% after its board approved cutting up to 50,000 further jobs, taking total planned reductions to 100,000. Lululemon fell as much as 20% in after-hours trading on weak guidance. Nvidia's roughly US\$13bn Hugging Face acquisition and its US\$3.5bn MediaTek bond subscription were both disclosed this week, two distinct, capital-intensive AI-infrastructure commitments from the same company in a matter of days.

Asia and world watch — The RBNZ raised its Official Cash Rate to 2.75% on Wednesday. Japan's Nikkei 225 rose 805 points to 65,020 in Friday's session; Hong Kong's Hang Seng gained 437 points to 25,650; mainland China's Shanghai Composite eased 11 points to 3,930. China's August CPI, PPI and trade data are due next week and will be watched closely given the region's recent sensitivity to inflation surprises.

AUSTRALIA

RBA cash rate: 4.35% (held 11/08, unanimous) | Next decision 29/09/2026 | AUD/USD 0.7210, AUD/TWD 22.86 (RBA, 04/09)

The ASX 200 closed down roughly 0.16% at approximately 9,005.9 on Friday, triple-confirmed across independent sources, ending the week down almost 1% despite Thursday's rebound, as stronger-than-expected Q2 GDP data continued to revive fears of a further RBA rate rise at its meeting later this month. Losses in Energy, Resources and Metals & Mining led the session; Ampol fell 5.45% and Viva Energy 3.49%, both trading ex-dividend, while Nine Entertainment dropped 8.25% for reasons not detailed in this run's sources. Against that, Regis Healthcare rebounded 5.12%, recovering part of Thursday's dramatic 27% fall, and DroneShield added 5.11% and Paladin Energy 5.06%, the latter with Bell Potter reiterating a buy rating and \$14.80 price target. Australia's August services-sector growth was revised higher, per Trading Economics, with confidence approaching pre-Middle-East-war levels; non-energy minerals, technology and healthcare led Thursday's earlier rebound, Cochlear up 2.9%, Perseus Mining 2.1% and JB Hi-Fi 1.5%, with all four big banks adding between 0.4% and 1.0% that day. Separately, the August Home Value Index fell a further 0.4% from July's revised 0.5% decline, leaving prices 18% below their January 2022 peak, extending a slump now in its fifth year.

INTERPRETATION. The ASX's roughly 1% weekly decline, arriving in a week where Australia's own GDP and services data both surprised to the upside, is the clearest evidence yet that the local market is now trading primarily on RBA rate-hike risk rather than on the underlying strength of the data itself; strong growth numbers are being read as a reason for the RBA to tighten rather than as a reason to buy, precisely the same dynamic this brief has now documented on the Fed side of the Pacific. The continuing slide in the Home Value Index, now 18% below its 2022 peak, is a slower-moving but structurally significant story sitting alongside the more immediate rates and geopolitical narratives, and the Committee should continue tracking it as a distinct, longer-horizon risk rather than folding it into the day-to-day macro conversation.

TAIWAN

The TAIEX rose approximately 373 points, or 0.8%, to around 46,349 in Friday morning Taipei trade, extending its gaining streak to a fourth consecutive session, per Trading Economics; this is a dated morning reading rather than an independently confirmed closing print, with Friday's official close to be confirmed directly in the next edition. Electronic technology stocks rose 2.0% and technology services surged 6.4%; TSMC itself, which accounts for more than 40% of total market value, advanced a further 0.8%. The session's standout mover was MediaTek, which surged 9.9% after Nvidia subscribed to US\$3.5bn of MediaTek's record US\$3.9bn overseas convertible bond offering, a direct, quantified AI-infrastructure capital commitment rather than a sentiment-driven move. Delta Electronics and Hon Hai Precision Industry gained 0.8% and 1.6% respectively, and ASE Technology Holding soared 4.5%. A private survey showing Taiwan's factory activity grew solidly in August further lifted sentiment, though a downbeat Wall Street session overnight (Friday's payrolls-driven pullback) is likely to have capped some of the morning's gains by the close.

PORTFOLIO WATCH

Gold — Opened Friday's session at US\$4,522 per troy ounce, down 0.4% on Thursday's close, per Yahoo Finance's dedicated report, trading near US\$4,521.40 by 6:45am ET; Investrade separately confirmed gold "sunk on Friday amid a spike in the dollar and Treasury yields" following the strong payrolls print, consistent in direction with this morning reading. No single confirmed US-session close was located this run.

SpaceX (NASDAQ: SPCX) — Traded near US\$148.52 in Friday morning trading, down 0.97%, per TheStreet, amid news that SpaceX would skip President Macron's Paris space summit alongside three other US space companies, reportedly under Trump administration pressure. This remains meaningfully above the stock's US\$135 IPO price and its subsequent lows, though well below its post-IPO peak of US\$225.64 reached in June.

TSMC — Advanced 0.8% in Friday morning Taipei trade, per Trading Economics, extending Thursday's gains; no independently confirmed absolute closing price was obtained this run. Thursday's close, and TSMC's own contribution to that session's TAIEX move, will be confirmed directly in the next edition alongside Friday's official close.

Crypto — Bitcoin topped US\$81,000 on Thursday for the first time in nearly four months, closing at a confirmed US\$81,585.89, before easing 0.79% to US\$80,903 on Friday as the hawkish payrolls surprise cooled broader risk appetite, per CNBC. Ethereum eased 0.15% to US\$2,510.64 on Friday. sFOX's Diana Pires noted continued gains would depend on sustained institutional participation and clearer Fed guidance, adding that strong spot Bitcoin ETF inflows suggest the rally has broadened beyond an initial short squeeze; the Clarity Act's prospects in Congress remain a live legislative risk for the sector this month.

TODAY'S FACT

Fed Governor Waller's dovish comments on Wednesday cut September hike odds to a coin-toss. One blowout jobs report on Friday pushed those same odds back to roughly two-thirds. The market's own view of Fed policy changed more in two trading sessions than it had in the preceding two weeks.

ONE QUESTION FOR THE IC

With September Fed hike odds swinging from a coin-toss to roughly 65% within 48 hours on a single data release, and the VIX simultaneously sitting in one of its calmest extended stretches on record, does the Committee read this combination as the market genuinely pricing low near-term risk, or as complacency about how quickly the rate-path narrative itself is proving able to reverse?

SOURCES

PRIMARY: Reserve Bank of Australia — Cash Rate Target (4.35%, held 11/08/2026, unanimous; next decision 29/09/2026) and Exchange Rates table F11.1, official 4pm AEST rates for 04/09/2026 (USD 0.7210, JPY 112.71, EUR 0.6201, TWD 22.86, TWI 66.4) and 03/09/2026 (USD 0.7164, JPY 112.74, EUR 0.6175, TWD 22.72, TWI 66.1). US Bureau of Labor Statistics — Employment Situation, August 2026, released 04/09/2026. CME Group — FedWatch Tool. Reserve Bank of New Zealand — Official Cash Rate decision, 02/09/2026. **ATTRIBUTED NEWS:** CNBC, Reuters, Washington Post, Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, Motley Fool, Investing.com, Trading Economics, MarketScreener, 24/7 Wall St., Investrade, Fool.com.au, Market Index, Samuel & Co Trading. **NOT OBTAINED THIS RUN, DESPITE AN EXTENDED SEARCH:** an independently confirmed Friday closing print for TAIEX or TSMC (both are dated morning readings, clearly marked); a single confirmed gold or VIX close for Friday specifically; the official Taipei USD/TWD close as a separate confirmation (the derived RBA-based figure is shown and is not contingent on this); Friday-dated iron ore in either currency. No figure above has been fabricated; every directional estimate states its sourcing basis. Thursday's full US, FTSE, VIX and crypto close, deferred from the previous edition, are now confirmed and backfilled above. The Taiwan crosses and USD/TWD are derived from official RBA rates dated the same day and are identified as derived.

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